CHURCH MANAGER

Master Setup, Deployment & Backup Guide

Offline Edition + LAN + Tailscale Edition + Vendor Licensing

1. Edition choice

- Offline: one computer, no server, LAN or Tailscale required.
- LAN + Tailscale: one designated Windows host, shared LAN database, authorized remote access through Tailscale.
- Keep the two editions separate; never merge their data folders.

2. Vendor license

- Run GENERATE-1YEAR.bat or GENERATE-LIFETIME.bat.
- Enter church name and optional customer reference.
- Send only the activation key. Keep vendor-private-key.pem private.
- The production application verifies Ed25519 digital signatures.

3. Host setup

- Install Node.js LTS.
- Extract Church-Manager-LAN-Tailscale.
- Run INSTALL-FIREWALL.bat as Administrator.
- Run CREATE-DESKTOP-SHORTCUT.bat.
- Use the desktop shortcut to start the server and open localhost:3000.
- Activate and create the Owner account.

4. LAN access

- Connect host and staff computers to the same trusted LAN.
- Run ipconfig on the host and use its IPv4 address followed by :3000 from another computer.
- Confirm staff permissions using separate accounts.

5. Tailscale remote access

- Install Tailscale on host and authorized remote devices.
- Sign in to the same trusted tailnet.
- Run tailscale ip -4 on the host.
- From the remote device use http://HOST-TAILSCALE-IP:3000.
- Do not port-forward TCP 3000. The host must be powered on and Church Manager running.

6. Staff roles

- Owner: full access, staff management, audit, backup/restore.
- Admin: operational sections and reports.
- Secretary: members, attendance, events, announcements.
- Treasurer: giving and reports.
- Worker: members and attendance.

7. Backup strategy

- The server creates a daily backup while running.
- INSTALL-DAILY-BACKUP.bat can create a Windows Task Scheduler backup at 11:55 PM.
- Owner can create/download backups from Backup & Restore.
- Use EXPORT-BACKUPS.bat and keep an external/off-computer copy.
- Backups contain sensitive church data and must be protected.

8. Restore

- Owner selects a known-good JSON backup in Backup & Restore.
- A pre-restore safety backup is created first.
- Restore replaces current records and invalidates active sessions.
- Sign in again after restoration.

9. Go-live checklist

- Test license activation.
- Test Owner and staff logins.
- Test LAN.
- Test Tailscale phone.
- Test host restart.
- Test manual backup.
- Test scheduled backup.
- Test restore with test records.
- Confirm no public router port forwarding.